

Chapter

An Open Challenge to the Hardcore Non-Vegetarian



Introduction: One Direct Question

Arguments about eating meat often run long — in the name of religion, tradition, taste and nutrition. Acharya Upendra Ji sets all these arguments aside and puts forward a single, direct question which, without any sermon, compels the listener to look within:

"My first question is — forget children, show me by eating yourself."

This question is not for any one religion or community, but for every person who eats meat and relishes it.

1. Leave the Chicken, Cut Your Own Portion

Speaking of dishes like chicken fry and bheja fry (fried brain), Acharya Ji says to leave them for once, and try the same experiment on your own body:

"Chicken fry, bheja fry — yes, all this, leave all that. Let the poor chicken roam around a little."

"Come on, cut a small portion of yourself, just this much, this little."

The challenge is especially for those who treat eating meat as a matter of pleasure:

"The one who eats non-veg with relish, enjoying its taste — for him, my open question to the hardcore non-veg, whatever religion he may be from."

2. Every Freedom in Cooking

Acharya Ji places no condition to make the challenge harder. On the contrary, he allows every means to enhance the taste:

"Cut a small piece like this every day. Put as much salt as you want, put oil, do that, put ghee — do whatever you want."

"Put curd in it, put all the vegetables in the world in it, turn it up and down however you like, chop it, do halal on it — do whatever you want."

The spices, the method, the style — all as you wish. Only one thing has changed: the meat on the plate is from your own body.

3. Cut It While Chanting a Mantra

Acharya Ji applies the same test to the belief that cutting meat while reciting a mantra makes it "pure":

"Cut it while chanting a mantra. Fine, it is said, isn't it — that if it is done while chanting a mantra it becomes pure — so cut it while chanting a mantra."

And he reminds us that he is asking for even less than what is taken from the animal — the animal loses its life:

"I am not even asking you to take a life. While cutting this small piece, chant the mantra, and cut, and eat. Will you be able to do it? Think it over and tell me."

If cutting with a mantra makes an act pure, then why not the same mantra while cutting a piece of your own body? The question shows that the pain we cannot bear ourselves is the very pain we give to another living being.

4. Open Challenge for Any Person on Planet Earth

Acharya Ji keeps this challenge open to the whole earth, and makes clear that it is not a one-day show:

"Open challenge for any person on planet Earth. And I am not talking about a stunt for one day — cut one piece every day."

The size of the piece is also your choice — only that it should be visible:

"The choice of the piece is yours, but it should be a sizable chunk. It should at least be visible, at least this much is needed."

5. Not Even As Much As You Eat

Finally, Acharya Ji draws attention to the gap that makes this challenge sharper still — he is not asking for even a fraction of the meat eaten on a daily plate:

"And how much you eat anyway! I am not asking you to cut even that much — I did not even say the size of that chicken, the size of that goat."

"Eat this much every day — cut a finger's worth like this, anything, fry it too, eat it. So who will be able to do it, tell me? This is an open challenge."

Not a whole chicken or goat, only a finger-sized piece — and still no one is ready. That itself is the answer to the question.

Summary: Key Teachings

- 1 **"Show me by eating yourself"** — what we cannot do to our own body is not right to do to another living being.
- 2 **The challenge is for meat-eaters of every religion**, especially those who eat meat for taste and pleasure.
- 3 **Every freedom of taste is given** — salt, oil, ghee, curd, vegetables, chop, halal — and still eating a piece of one's own body seems impossible.
- 4 **Chanting a mantra while cutting does not erase the pain** — merely imagining cutting your own piece while chanting a mantra is the test of this belief.

- 5 The demand is not even for a life, nor for the size of a whole animal — just one visible piece every day. And this is an open challenge for any person on planet Earth.